# C.A.P.E Meeting Minutes

**September 18, 2026**

**Board Members in Attendance:** Blair Kramer, Megan Vainowski, La Toya Forester Williams, Veronica Fisher, and Andrea Phillips.

**Call to Order:** Meeting called to order by CAPE President Blair Kramer at **9:31** am. All present recited The Pledge of Allegiance led by Veronica Fisher

**Reminder, this is a closed meeting.

**Roll Call:** Roll call taken.

**CAPE Reps:**

| | | | | | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| x | Bonnie McBeth | x | Central Elem. | x | Charles Reed | x | Creekside | x | Crystal Lawns |
| x | Eagle Point | | Eichelberger | | Freedom | x | Grand Prairie | x | Lakewood Falls |
| x | Liberty | x | Lincoln | x | Meadowview | x | Ridge | | River View |
| x | Thomas Jefferson | | Walker's Grove | x | Wallin Oaks | x | Wesmere | x | Aux Sable |
| x | Drauden Point | x | Heritage Grove | x | Indian Trail | x | Ira Jones | x | JFK |
| | Timber Ridge | | Plainfield Academy | x | PCHS | | PEHS | x | PNHS |
| x | PSHS | | | | | | | | |

**Administration Reports:**

**Community Relations Report - Kelly Larson**

- New Administration Introductions
- Horizon Grant: let current Juniors know
- 2 students serving on the ISBE student advisory council

**Ross Draper, PNHS:**

- Homecoming events/ games and dances
- Alice Training
- Staff recognition for milestone years served in the district
- Juniors received merit recognition
- 2 perfect ACT scores
- YH4L at Central October 6th, East March 23rd

**Mike Romelli, Heritage Grove MS:**

- Fall sports
- 7th Grade Outdoor Ed.
- Homecoming float prep
- Battle of the Books, books announced

- Alice Training

**Tyler Haymond, Creekside ES and Spencer the service dog:**

- Alice Training: I'm Not Scared, I'm Prepared book
- Cultural Fair and Central Elem. Oct. 6th
- SIP day 9/21 - NO SCHOOL
- Homecoming Floats in the work
- PTC Fast for Parent/Teacher conferences
- Hearing and Vision Screenings
- Creekside wrapped up their fundraiser with over $17k raised
    - Day of awesome: Bounce houses and Principal on the roof
- Vitt Factor Assembly
- It's service dog month!

**PNHS Student CAPE Representative - Simi Kolawole & Justin Bohn**

- Challenges: Senior overwhelm with college admission
    - College fairs are helping
- How can we make sure students are feeling engaged and challenged in the classroom?
    - Parents: Home Access Center and school social media feeds will help
    - Coming to school. Attendance starts of strong as Freshmen and Sophomores, but Junior and Seniors tend to fall off a bit

**Assistant Superintendent of Curriculum & Instruction: Dr. Paula Sereleas**

- Curriculum Coordinating Council
    - Priority: How do we increase family engagement?
    - Shared responsibility and partnership
        - The plan is a joint agreement outline how parents, staff, and students share responsibility for improved academic achievement. It serves as a foundation for building a bridge between home and school.
- Summer Student Internship
    - Will County Summer Internship Program
        - 1,200 applications and only 170 spots
        - They need more employers
            - Minimum age and up
        - Tell everyone you know

**Amy Nowak: PPCN**

- Dr. Joe Sweeney: October 1st at 6:30p at PHS-CC
    - 10 things parents can do from kindergarten through senior year

**APT President - Stephen Jepsen:**

- Many new members
- Bowling league: proceeds going to Tom Hernandez Foundation
- Trunk or Treat at the YMCA
- Tattoos by Teachers at local 5k

**Community Reports:**

**Plainfield Public Library - Katie Gulas**

- Summer reading program success!
- 3 Plainfield students participated in the summer internship program
    - 1 hired on officially for social media
- Bringing back Sunday hours: 1-5p through Mothers Day
- Reading Dragon and friends: ages 5 & up
- Halloween walk October 24th with spooktacular 11-1
- Magic Show October 17th, bilingual show - sign up
- All abilities bingo program
- Sensory kits available
- Revamped teen volunteer program: grades 7 & up

- Leadership league: 9-12 graders

**Joliet Library - Laura Yanchick**

- 4 teen interns
- Glow night next Friday: Black Rd. location
- Library card sign-up month
  - Sign up babies

**YMCA - Shannon Stawikowski**

- Before and after school programs still have availability
- Alice training
- Will County Summer Internship
- Dance Team: Sideline dance program with performance during outdoor sports
- Halloween Spooktacular: Saturday October 17th
  - Bouncehouses, crafts, games
  - Looking for small businesses and personal trunks for trunk or treat
- Basketball Leagues are open for registration

**President Report: Blair Kramer**

- QR coder agenda for the CAPE Cafe
- Rep folder info coming
- CAPE awareness: lanyard info needed for tags
- CAPE leadership: election for President, VP, and Secretary

**Secretary's Report: Megan Vainowski**

- Motion to file minutes from: Jamie Harris: Wesmere and Elizabeth Hespell: Lakewood Falls

**Treasurer's Report: LaToya Forrester**

- Beginning Balance: $9,745.89
- Ending Check Balance: $ 11,310.92
- Motion to file: Jamie Harris: Wesmere, Roy Hardy: Ridge

**Old Business**

- Homecoming
  - Thank you Lakewood Falls for volunteering 4 people for the parade!
  - No performing along the route
  - Pay attention to the Stop/Go sign holders
  - Only schools need to stop for judges
  - Bands keep going
  - 30 sec for dance/cheer
  - No confetti guns or throwing candy
  - Please remind groups not to approach judges
  - Parade details are coming this weekend

**New Business**

- Parent Group 101: Monday October 19th at 5p
- Thanks to Ground for Good for the coffee

**Adjournment:** Meeting ended at 11:01 Jamie Harris: Wesmere Linda Ray: Crystal Lawns

**Next Meeting Is:** October 16, 2026 at 9:30a